

TikTok has become a key driver of economic, social, and cultural transformation in Saudi Arabia. With strong user engagement and an innovative ecosystem, the platform supports economic growth, SMB development, entrepreneurship, and cultural exchange. Today, **more than 170,000 SMBs** and **over 1 Mn creators** leverage TikTok to connect with audiences, engage with customers, and drive innovation. As Saudi Arabia advances toward its Vision 2030 aspirations, TikTok continues to play a vital role in economic diversification and digital empowerment, shaping a more dynamic and inclusive future.

1. TikTok fuels KSA's economic growth by boosting SMB earnings

Supporting Saudi Arabia's goal of increasing SMBs' GDP contribution to 35% by 2030, TikTok helps businesses scale, innovate, and compete in an increasingly digital economy, contributing to GDP growth and job creation.

- a. Impacting KSA's GDP¹:** SMB use of TikTok contributed SAR 3.9 Bn to GDP in 2024.
- b. Creating Jobs:** SMB use of TikTok also supported 25,000 jobs in the KSA in 2024.

2. TikTok empowers consumer choices

TikTok shapes purchasing decisions, driving spending, brand engagement, and economic value for users.

- a. Spend Influence:** TikTok influences² 9% of expenditure, or SAR 110 Bn annually.
- b. Brand Value:** TikTok generates SAR 19 Bn in consumer surplus³ across KSA.

3. TikTok fosters innovation and an entrepreneurial spirit

TikTok empowers creators and SMBs by enhancing brand visibility, expanding audience reach, and increasing revenue potential while fostering a strong entrepreneurial culture.

- a. Transforming the Creator Economy**
 - Self-Employment: 30% of creators attribute their start to TikTok.⁴
 - Reach: 54% of creators find TikTok more effective for audience engagement.
 - Earnings: 32% of creators derive significant⁵ earnings through TikTok.
- b. Empowering SMBs**
 - Brand Visibility: 61% of SMBs report improved visibility via TikTok.
 - Innovation: 48% of SMBs launch new offerings based on TikTok feedback.
- Entrepreneurship Culture: 55% of SMBs strongly agree that TikTok motivates youth to start businesses; 23% of women SMB owners credit TikTok for inspiring them to start a venture.
- c. Maximizing Earnings Efficiently**
 - Efficiency: 42% of SMBs acknowledge that TikTok saves them significant time on marketing.
 - Revenue Uplift: SAR 3 Bn increase in revenue from TikTok paid advertising and the use of TikTok's free services.

4. TikTok has built a strong community

The KSA community has embraced TikTok, spending time on learning, exploring culture, and meeting shopping needs. By connecting communities and amplifying Saudi Arabia's cultural and economic presence, TikTok continues to shape a digitally engaged and globally connected society.

- a. Enhancing Creativity and Skill Development**
 - Skill Building: 62% of nationals credit TikTok for skill enhancement.
 - Creativity: 38% of the KSA audience⁶ strongly agree (83% agree) that TikTok's creators drive trends and innovation.
- b. Promoting Cultural Heritage**
 - Cultural Expression: 39% of nationals strongly agree that TikTok aids in sharing cultural identity.
- National Pride: 48% of nationals strongly agree (88% agree) that TikTok fosters national pride.
- Domestic Tourism: 42% of the KSA audience discovered KSA destinations via TikTok.
- c. Elevating Global Identity**
 - International Tourism: 30% of the global audience⁷ is inspired to visit KSA after engaging with content on TikTok.
 - Global Image: 25% of the global audience credit TikTok for boosting KSA's global image in sports, culture, and tourism.

¹ Indicates economic impact of SMBs revenue generated through paid advertising on TikTok and the use of TikTok's free service.

² Figure is based on the survey, where respondents were asked about TikTok's influence on spending across key sectors such as fashion, beauty, food service and automotive.

³ Value that users would be hypothetically willing to pay for a TikTok free service, or, conversely, what they would be willing to accept to forego access of TikTok.

⁴ Unless specified, all the claims highlighted above represent users who strongly agree with the statements.

⁵ "Significant" indicates >30% increase in revenue, as per survey conducted by Redseer Strategy Consultants. 'earnings' typically refer to brand deals, while 'rewards' come from TikTok-to-TikTok Live Creators. However, this study did not differentiate between the two. Hence, we have used 'earnings' interchangeably with 'rewards' in this study.

⁶ TikTok users (both nationals and expats) in KSA who participated in the survey.

⁷ TikTok users in UK and USA who participated in the survey.